GOLDENROD SHOOTS AND MAPLE PECANS

serves 4

Many of us know goldenrod for its swaths of yellow blooms that signal summer is about to transition to fall. While goldenrod has many medicinal uses, the plant is also edible. In spring, when the shoots first appear, they are tender enough to eat raw. As they grow, but before they flower, you can blanch the shoots. Their bitter, ever-so-slightly celery-like flavor is best with rich sauces, like a Duck Egg Aioli (page 36). I add a sprinkle of candied pecans, too, for extra sweetness and crunch.

- ¼ cup pecan halves
- 1 teaspoon sunflower oil
- 1½ teaspoons maple syrup
- ¼ teaspoon fine sea salt, plus more as needed
- 16 tender young goldenrod shoots or 8 midseason shoots
- 2 teaspoons cider vinegar
- ½ cup Duck Egg Aioli (page 36), for serving

Preheat a toaster oven or other oven to 250°F.

Spread the pecans on a small baking sheet and toast for about 10 minutes, or until fragrant. Pull out the pan just long enough to toss the pecans with the oil, 1 teaspoon of the maple syrup, and the salt and toast for about 10 minutes longer, or until dry to the touch. Let cool, then coarsely chop.

If you're using early-season shoots, you can just coarsely chop them.

If you're using midseason shoots, bring a large pot of water to a boil over high heat and salt it well. Remove the lower leaves from the midseason shoots to reveal the stems but keep the top leaves. Add the shoots to the water and boil for about 1 minute, or until bright green and just tender. Drain in a colander, then pat dry with a towel.

In a large bowl, whisk together the vinegar and remaining ½ teaspoon of maple syrup. Add the raw or blanched shoots and toss.

Use the duck egg aioli to create a large smear on a platter. Arrange the shoots on top and sprinkle with the candied pecans.

boil over high heat, then reduce the heat to medium-high and cook the syrup vigorously without stirring. Keep an eye on the syrup to make sure it doesn't boil over.

Once the syrup's temperature reaches between 257° and 262°F, remove the pan from the heat. Start to stir the syrup with a wooden spoon; it will start to turn granular within a couple

When the sugar is cooled, shake it through a fine-mesh sieve to help sift it. If any large clumps remain, pulse them in a food processor or blender until they are finely ground and add to the remaining sugar. Store for several months in an airtight container.

DUCK EGG AIOLI

makes about 1¼ cups

This is a bit of an Indigenous mother sauce. Perhaps not traditional, but it's what I reach for whenever I want to add a bit of richness to the plate. This recipe works best in a mini food processor or the smaller bowl of your food processor (if you have the option), but you can also make it in a blender, immersion blender, or whisking by hand. Whatever you do, just make sure to add the oil very slowly to help the emulsion form.

- 1 duck egg
- 1 tablespoon cider vinegar
- 1 to 2 garlic cloves, finely grated
- ½ teaspoon musta powder
- ⅛ teaspoon fine se salt
- 1 cup sunflower oi

In a mini food processor, blend the egg for about 20 seconds, until fully combined and slightly aerated. Add the vinegar, garlic, mustard powder, and salt and blend for another 20 seconds, until well combined. Scrape down the sides of the bowl.

With the machine running, gradually add the oil, starting with a few drops at a time and later a very thin stream to develop a thick, emulsified sauce.

Transfer to an airtight container and refrigerate for up to 2 weeks.